The state used the surplus appropriated for the development of the rural economy by founding new settlements, granting land and encouraging the people to settle as farmers. It also organised irrigation projects and controlled the distribution of water. There was state control of agriculture, mining, industry and trade. The state discouraged the emergence of private property in land and banned its sale. The Mauryan state gave further boost to urban development. It secured land trade routes to Iran and Mesopotamia, as well as to the kingdoms of northern China. *Arthasastra* refers to Kasi (Benares), Vanga (Bengal), Kamarupa (Assam) and Madurai as textile centres. The distribution of black polished ware of northern India as far as South India is indicative of the extent of trade during the Mauryan rule. Trade contributed to urbanisation in a big way. New cities such as Kaushambi, Bhita, Vaishali and Rajagriha had sprung up in the *doab* region.

Educational Centres

Monasteries and temples served the purpose of imparting education. Nalanda was a great monastery built by the Magadha Empire. Educational centres offered Buddhist and Vedic literature, logic, grammar, medicine, philosophy and astronomy. Even the science of war was taught. Nalanda became the most renowned seat of learning in course of time. It was supported by the revenues of 100 villages. No fees were charged to the students and they were provided free board and lodging.



Nalanda University

Recap

- Sixth century BC (BCE) was a period of material, cultural and intellectual development.
- Confucius' ethics in China and Zoroastrian religion in Persia, Mahavira's Tri-ratnas and Buddha's eight-fold path in India created a new awakening and provided a moral code of conduct to humanity.
- Sixth century BC (BCE) was also a period that witnessed the rise of Mahajanapadas. The sixteen such chiefdoms are listed with the focus on Magadha as a powerful kingdom.
- The Mauryan dynasty was founded by Chandragupta Maurya with the aid of Chanakya.
- The Mauryan administration and the greatness of Ashoka with particular reference to his dhamma is highlighted.

EXERCISE

69DME

I. Choose the correct answer

1. Identify the founder of a new sect who exemplified simplicity and self-denial.

   (a) Buddha (b) Lao-tze

   (c) Confucius (d) Zoroaster

2. The Magadha king influenced by the teachings of Mahavira

   (a) Dhanananda

   (b) Chandragupta

   (c) Bimbisara

   (d) Shishunaga

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